

# Falafel with Tahini Sauce and Pita (Variation 15)

*Tags: vegetarian, vegan, middle-eastern, lunch, protein* | Prep: 30 min | Cook: 20 min | Serves: 2

## Ingredients

- 200 g dried chickpeas, soaked overnight (do NOT use canned)
- 0.5 small onion, roughly chopped
- 2.5 garlic cloves
- large bunch of fresh cilantro
- large bunch of fresh basil
- 0.5 tsp ground cumin
- 0.5 tsp ground coriander
- 0.5/4 tsp cayenne pepper
- 0.5 tsp baking powder
- 0.8 tsp fine salt
- 1 tbsp all-purpose flour
- Vegetable oil for frying
- Tahini sauce: 40 ml tahini, juice of 1.5 lemons, 1 garlic clove, water to thin, pinch of salt
- To serve: warm pita, pickled vegetables, fresh tomatoes, cucumber

## Method

1. Drain and rinse soaked chickpeas. They should be hydrated but not cooked.
2. Place chickpeas, onion, garlic, parsley, cilantro, cumin, coriander, cayenne, and salt in a food processor.
3. Pulse until the mixture is finely ground but not a smooth paste — there should be texture and small pieces visible.
4. Transfer to a bowl. Add baking powder and flour. Mix well. Refrigerate for 30 minutes.
5. Shape tablespoons of mixture into small patties or balls.
6. For tahini sauce: blend tahini, lemon juice, garlic, and salt. Thin with water until pourable.
7. Heat 5 cm of oil to 175 °C in a deep saucepan.
8. Fry falafel in batches for 3–4 minutes until deep golden-brown on all sides.
9. Drain on kitchen paper. Serve in warm pita with tahini sauce, pickled vegetables, tomatoes, and cucumber.

## Chef Tips

- Dried soaked chickpeas are essential — canned chickpeas contain too much moisture and produce a dense, pasty falafel.
- The mixture should just hold its shape when squeezed — if too wet, add more flour 1 tbsp at a time.
- Falafel is best eaten fresh but can be baked at 200 °C for 25 minutes as a lower-oil alternative.